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THE AI OUTLOOK 2026



How Intelligent Technologies
Reshape Enterprise Value

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Introduction

How AI is becoming a core business capability

Artificial intelligence has entered a phase of broad-based adoption that is changing the foundations of business, science, and productivity. What began as a set of isolated pilots is now a pervasive capability reshaping every major industry.

We have moved past the question of whether AI will redefine the enterprise world to confronting the urgent challenge of harnessing its power effectively. With 78% of organizations using AI in at least one business function (up from 55% just a year earlier), we are witnessing one of the most rapid technology adoption curves in enterprise history. This is not a gradual evolution but an acceleration that demands immediate attention from industry leaders.

As adoption accelerates, so does the scale of economic opportunity. The financial stakes are unprecedented. Analytical AI technologies – including machine learning and deep learning – are projected to generate between \$9.4 trillion and \$15 trillion in economic value by 2040. Generative AI alone could contribute an additional \$2.6 trillion to \$4.4 trillion annually through enterprise applications, with 75% of this value concentrated in four critical domains: customer operations, marketing and sales, software engineering, and research and development. Combined, the total economic potential ranges from \$15.5 trillion to \$22.9 trillion annually.

